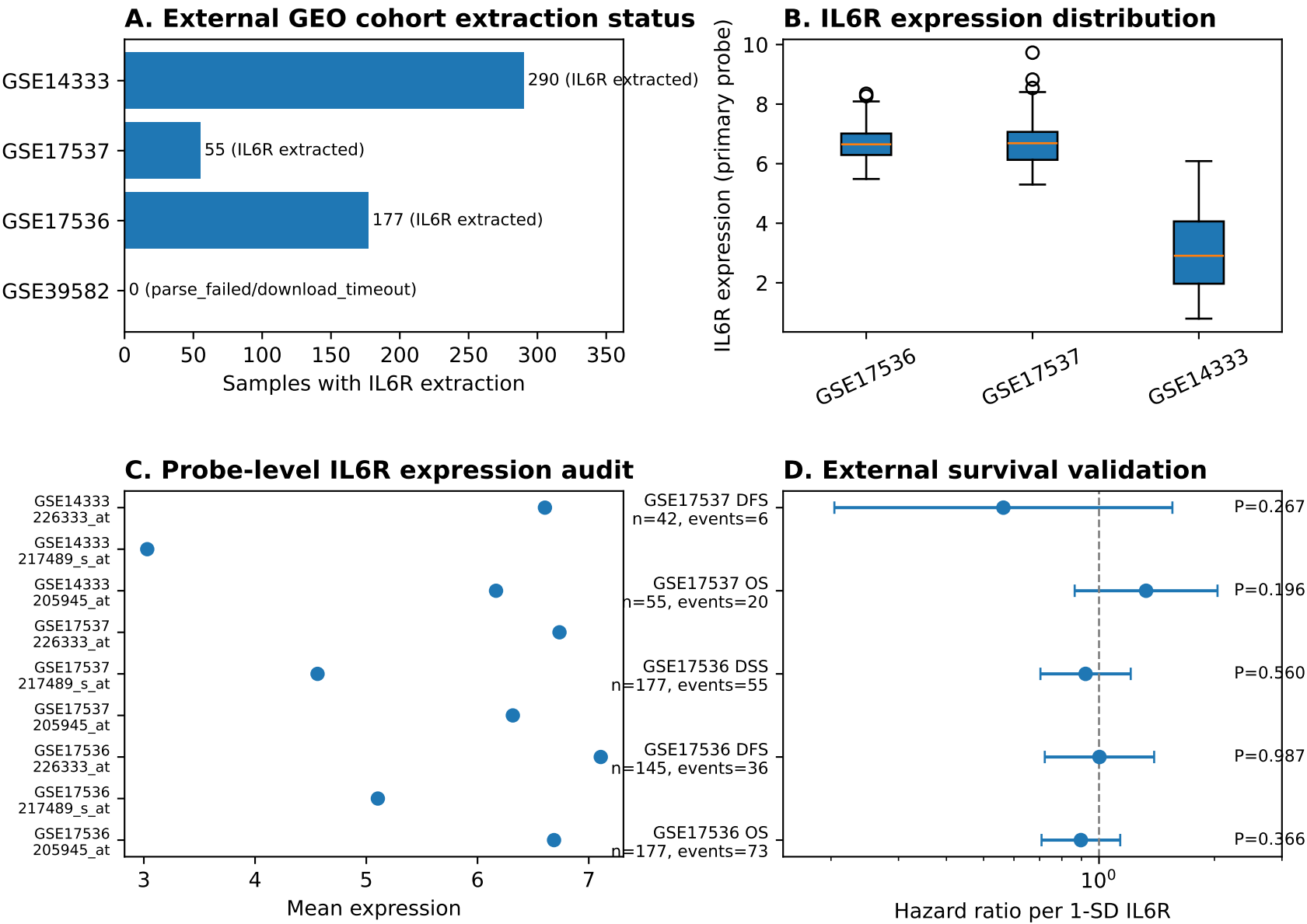


Supplementary Figure S1. External GEO validation of IL6R expression and prognostic association



E. Interpretation summary

IL6R expression was successfully extracted from three external GEO CRC cohorts (GSE17536, GSE17537 and GSE14333; total n=522). GSE39582 could not be parsed in the current run because the GEO/GPL download timed out. Automated tumour-normal validation was not claimed because no cohort had a reliable tumour/normal split in the available metadata. Univariable Cox checks in GSE17536 and GSE17537 did not support a robust IL6R prognostic association, consistent with the repaired TCGA OS/PFI analysis.